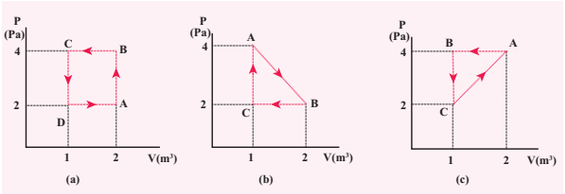
EXAMPLE 8.22

The PV diagrams for a thermodynamical system is given in the figure below. Calculate the total work done in each of the cyclic processes shown.



Solution

In the case (a) the closed curve is anticlockwise. So the net work done is negative, implying that the work done on the system is greater than the work done by the system. The area under the curve BC will give work done on the gas (isobaric compression) and area under the curve DA (work done by the system) will give the total work done by the system.

Area under the curve BC = Area of rectangle BC12 = $1 \times 4 = -4J$

Area under the curve DA = $1 \times 2 = +2J$

Net work done in cyclic process
$= -4 + 2 = -2$ J

In the case (b) the closed curve is clockwise. So the net work done is positive, implying that the work done on the system is less than the work done by the system. Area under the curve BC will give work done on the gas (isobaric compression) and area under the curve AB will give the total work done by the system.

Area under the curve AB = rectangle area+ triangle area = $(1\times2) + \frac{1}{2} \times 1\times2 = +3J$

Area under the curve BC = rectangle area $= 1 \times 2 = -2J$

Network done in the cyclic process = 1 J, which is positive.

In the case (c) the closed curve is anticlockwise. So the net work done is negative, implying that the work done on the system is greater than work done by the system. The area under the curve AB will give the work done on the gas (isobaric compression) and area under the curve CA (work done by the system) will give the total work done by the system.

The area under the curve AB =Rectangle of area = $4 \times 1 = -4J$

The area under the curve CA = Rectangle area + triangle area = $(1\times2) + \frac{1}{2} \times 1\times2 = +3J$

The total work in the cyclic process = -1 J. It is negative

8.8.7 Limitations of first law of thermodynamics

The first law of thermodynamics explains well the inter convertibility of heat and work. But it does not indicate the direction of change.

For example,

a. When a hot object is in contact with a cold object, heat always flows from the hot object to cold object but not in the reverse direction. According to first law, it is possible for the energy to flow from hot object to cold object or from cold object to hot object. But in nature the direction of heat flow is always from higher temperature to lower temperature.

b. When brakes are applied, a car stops due to friction and the work done against friction is converted into heat. But this

UNIT-8(XI-Physics_Vol-2).indd 140 17-08-2020 16:17:35